

# Scoop: Germany sets its position on IAA

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## 【要点】

- ・ドイツはEUの産業加速法（IAA）において「EU製」アプローチの採用を推進しており、貿易相手国との関係維持と保護主義の回避を重視している。
- ・ドイツは外国直接投資ルールについて、重要産業を保護するため正当な理由がある場合の適用除外を求めている。
- ・IAAの重要要素である大型外国投資家への技術移転要件により、バッテリーや電気自動車などの戦略的産業における外国企業の進出が規制される。
- ・ドイツは第三国企業がEU域内生産を通じてEU原産地資格を得る抜け穴を塞ぐよう求めており、他国の首都や議員も同様の懸念を示している。
- ・ドイツはアジア経済、特に中国の自動車産業への影響を懸念しており、プラグインハイブリッド車などへの保護措置を検討している。

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## 【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By JORDYN DAHL with MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — Berlin is pushing for the EU to

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By JORDYN DAHL

with MARTINA SAPIO

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SNEAK PEEK

— Berlin is pushing for the EU to adopt a “Made with EU” approach in the Industrial Accelerator Act, according to a document obtained by POLITICO.

— Major political questions remain unresolved on military mobility even after Parliament and Council reached provisional agreement on much of the technical machinery.

— Europe’s future electric-truck charging demand will be heavily concentrated in a few places, a new report found.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Tips to [jdahl@politico.eu](mailto:jdahl@politico.eu) , [tlecca@politico.eu](mailto:tlecca@politico.eu) and [msapio@politico.eu](mailto:msapio@politico.eu) . Follow us [@tommylecca](#) , [@jordyndahl](#) and [@martsapio](#) .

DRIVING THE DAY

SCOOP — GERMAN POSITION PAPER ON IAA: Berlin is pushing for the EU to adopt a “Made with EU” approach on the Industrial Accelerator Act, according to a German position paper obtained by POLITICO . While no other EU capitals have signed on to the paper, Berlin will push for that approach in Council negotiations.

The impetus: Germany’s economy relies on exports — particularly of machinery, chemicals and vehicles — and its lawmakers are wary of angering trade partners. “The EU must remain a reliable partner for its free trade partners and uphold its legal obligations thereof,” the paper reads. “Germany rejects protectionism and discrimination.”

No surprises: As we scooped earlier , Germany sent the Commission a position paper before the IAA was put forward, advocating for a Made with Europe approach. Its lawmakers in the center-right European People’s Party are also pushing this approach .

Some exemptions: Berlin also wants capitals to have the ability to apply for an exemption to proposed foreign direct investment rules “in duly justified cases” that would safeguard “critical industries.” This request was first seen in a German federal status report in August.

All about China: Berlin is wary of Beijing lashing out against German automakers. But Chancellor Friedrich Merz and his ruling coalition have signaled a desire to take a more robust approach toward China, including potential safeguards on plug-in hybrid cars.

Strengthen tech transfers: A key component of the IAA is technology transfer requirements for large foreign investors from countries that account for over 40% of global manufacturing capacity in strategic sectors like batteries, electric vehicles, solar, and critical minerals.

Yes, but: Wary of circumvention measures, Germany wants to close loopholes that would allow third-country companies to obtain EU origin status by setting up production in an approved partner. Other capitals and lawmakers have raised similar concerns .

\*\*The Brussels Playbook Capitals newsletter helps readers understand how positions are shifting, where the pressure is building and what Brussels should be watching next. Sign up here .\*\*

## MILITARY MOBILITY

MILITARY MOBILITY STILL HAS A WAY TO GO: Parliament and EU governments have provisionally agreed on much of the technical machinery behind the military mobility regulation. However, major questions remain over emergency powers, NATO treatment and access to scarce transport assets ahead of a hoped-for deal in December, according to a mid-September internal document seen by Martina.

What’s nearly sorted: Negotiators have largely settled the basic system for getting military convoys across borders. There are draft agreements providing for standing permissions rather than requiring permits for every movement, timelines mandating decisions on issuing transport permissions, traffic arrangements and practical support such as refueling, parking or medical assistance. As well, there is agreement on certificates and administrative simplifications for civilian companies moving military cargo.

Paperwork is getting there too: There is also broad agreement on the architecture of a new EU military-mobility digital system and on simplifying customs through a common NATO and EU form. That was one of the biggest administrative headaches before the reform. The provisionally-agreed system would be run by the Commission and be restricted to authorized users. It would store its data in the EU

and include fallback procedures if it goes down.

But how fast is fast? An unresolved issue is the deadline for when a movement is not covered by a standing authorization. Parliament, Council and the Commission differ over whether countries should have two, three or five days to answer.

The emergency button: The biggest fight is over EMMERS, the proposed emergency regime that would allow normal transport rules to be relaxed when countries need to move troops and equipment at much greater speed or scale. Negotiators disagree over what should trigger it, whether it should apply across the EU or only in specified areas, how long it can run and how much freedom there should be to activate, change or terminate it. The original Commission proposal gave much of that power to the Commission itself, but both Council and Parliament have since pushed back — especially on the idea that, if EMMERS is triggered in one country, it should extend across the whole Union. Council, in particular, is not keen.

And then there's NATO: Parts of the rules governing NATO countries have been agreed, but the main clause determining how non-EU NATO allies are treated under the system is still open. That matters because European military movements frequently involve non-EU allies such as the U.K., the U.S. and Norway — so an EU-only system that does not mesh cleanly with NATO procedures would leave a sizable practical gap.

The asset fight: Arguably the most politically sensitive piece is the proposed Solidarity Pool, designed to identify and share scarce dual-use assets — think specialized rail wagons, vehicles, vessels or logistics capacity. The idea is to ask countries to identify and “pool” the assets that could be used in a crisis. The difficult part is deciding who gets access when several countries need the same asset, how much control the country providing it retains, and how civilian operators are protected when it comes to liability, insurance and costs.

December blues: Much of the administrative machinery is falling into place, but what remains are the issues governments care most about — sovereignty over their territory, control of national assets and who gets to make the call when civilian transport has to give way to military needs. Negotiators are still at it this week, with another military mobility working party meeting scheduled for Friday. That makes the package's end-of-year deadline for agreement, floated by the Irish Council presidency, look rather ambitious.

## CARS

EV SALES UP ACROSS THE EU: High energy prices from the war in Iran, coupled with new subsidy programs such as Germany's, have boosted the share of electric vehicle new registrations across the EU to nearly 22% at the end of August, up from almost 16% a year ago, according to data released today from the European Automobile Manufacturers' Association.

By the numbers: In the first eight months of the year, 1.64 million EVs were sold. France posted the biggest gain with sales increasing 74% to 322,099. Germany's EV sales grew 53% to 515,545.

Continued decline: The combined share of petrol and diesel cars, meanwhile, dropped from 37.5% in 2025 to 29% at the end of August this year.

More bad news: Embattled German automaker Volkswagen sold almost 2 million cars in the first eight months of the year, a mere 1.3% increase over the same period last year. Mercedes and BMW fared only slightly better, growing 3.5% and 4.8%, respectively. The three are facing massive job cuts and

potential factory closures.

The winners are Chinese carmakers. BYD sales grew from 67,600 in the first eight months of 2025 to 178,000 in the same period this year, a 163% jump. Leapmotor did even better, with sales growing by 430% from 11,800 in 2025 to 62,500 this year. The Chinese automaker is partnered with Stellantis and is using its distribution channels to sell EVs and hybrids.

## TRUCKS

**E-TRUCK CHARGING IS ALL ABOUT LOCATION:** Europe's future electric-truck charging demand will be heavily concentrated in a relatively small number of places. That suggests grid operators and governments may not need to upgrade everything everywhere at once, according to new research from the ICCT out today. The study looks at expected charging demand across the EU, the U.K., Norway and Switzerland through 2045.

**Follow the trucks:** The researchers found that just the top 10% of charging locations could account for 60% to 90% of a country's total electric-truck charging demand, with hotspots clustering around major freight corridors, motorway junctions, metropolitan areas and industrial hubs. In some countries, the busiest 1% of locations account for roughly a quarter to a third of demand.

**And demand adds up:** Under the researchers' more supportive policy scenario, Europe's electric trucks would consume around 100 TWh of power a year by 2035, rising to about 200 TWh by 2045. Germany, France, the U.K., Spain and Italy are expected to account for the largest shares.

## RAIL

**NIGHT TRAIN REVIVAL BID:** Europe's night-train revival has had a rough ride, but one of the startups trying to make the model work is moving from plans to an actual service. Berlin-based Nox Mobility unveiled its first completed coach at InnoTrans on Wednesday and says it will launch a Hamburg–Munich night service in March, running three times a week in each direction via Bremen and Augsburg.

**Why it matters:** The night train market has been held back by the same stubborn problems for years — expensive and scarce rolling stock, high operating costs and the difficulty of getting new services onto the rails. Nox is trying to work around some of that by using leased and refurbished coaches rather than waiting years for new trains.

## PIT STOPS

**From us :** German companies are stockpiling critical raw materials, alarmed by the risk that Beijing could restrict rare earth exports if next month's trade talks between the EU and China break down.

## Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

German industry hoards rare earths as Brussels squares up to China

Companies fear Europe's push to rebalance trade with Beijing could trigger retaliation against critical supply chains.

By Frida Preuss, Carlo Martuscelli · Sept 24, 2026, 06:00 am Europe/Brussels CEST

Trump-Xi meeting puts rare earth truce to the test

President Donald Trump's meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping this week could decide the fate of an expiring mineral truce that's crucial for autos, energy and the Pentagon.

By Hannah Northey, James Bikales · Sept 23, 2026, 09:57 am Europe/Brussels CEST

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